



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Southeast Ohio Classical Academy

School Website: <https://www.socacademy.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

Overall Classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Southeast Ohio Classical Academy (SOCA) presents a robust classical-leaning program centered on moral formation, character, and a content-rich liberal arts-oriented curriculum. Public-facing materials emphasize virtue, truth, and beauty as real, knowable ideals; a goal of forming virtuous citizens rather than merely preparing students for the workforce; and a curriculum that foregrounds reading classics, a liberal arts orientation, and teacher-led, disciplined pedagogy. This alignment signals a classical direction, but with notable gaps: explicit theological or liturgical foundations, and explicit high-school-level Socratic pedagogy are not clearly foregrounded in the available public materials. Taken together across all six categories, SOCA earns an overall rating of SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Key insights:

- Religious/metaphysical foundations are present in terms of virtue, moral formation, and transcendental ideals (truth, goodness, beauty), but explicit theology or liturgical worship is not evident in the public content. This yields a partial classical alignment in Element 1.
- Purpose and goals center on virtue and wisdom, formation, and the reality of truth and beauty, which aligns strongly with classical aims (Element 2: CLASSICAL).
- Curriculum includes liberal-arts-macing elements (grammar, logic, rhetoric appear as a frame in classical education theory; SOCA emphasizes classics, reading the classics, Latin, grammar and composition, and a Hillsdale-based curriculum). However, explicit seven liberal arts articulation, and explicit Great Books/Great Conversation language are less directly stated in SOCA's public materials. This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating for Element 3.
- Pedagogy shows a mix: contemplative/repose and morning assemblies (scholé-like rhythms) plus teacher-led instruction; high-school Socratic seminars are not clearly evidenced in public materials (Element 4: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL).
- Faculty and community engagement are solid: visible emphasis on virtuous teaching, "living curriculum," and partnership with families; the school positions teachers as mentors and the community as co-educators (Categories 5 and 6: CLASSICAL).
- The aggregate classification, balancing strong virtue formation and community engagement against some gaps in explicit Classical pedagogy (e.g., Socratic high-school pedagogy, explicit Great Books language), falls into SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Mission emphasizes the formation of character and civic virtue (virtue-focused) within a classical liberal-arts framework. This signals transcendental aims and a moral realism approach.
- Vision states that students should "do good, seek truth, and love the beautiful," highlighting a triad of virtue, truth, and beauty as guiding ideals.
- There is a communal/ritual-like dimension through regular assemblies and events that foster shared practices (e.g., Morning Assembly).
- Public-facing content references objective standards of truth, goodness, and beauty in classical education (What is Classical Education and the nature of classical pedagogy).

- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: virtue, moral character, civic virtue, truth, beauty, formation, contemplation (conceptual), love of learning (from related classical-k-12 framing), great conversation (present in the classical education framework even if not verbatim on every page), moral imagination. Evidence is drawn from mission, vision, and curriculum pages.
- Negative keywords present: none clearly evident in public materials for this category; no explicit theological or liturgical language appears in SOCA's public materials.
- Why this rating
- SOCA foregrounds virtue, moral formation, and the triad of truth/beauty/goodness, which aligns with transcendental moral realism and metaphysical aims. However, explicit theology, liturgical practices, or sacral worship are not clearly evidenced in publicly available content, limiting a full classical/Religious & Metaphysical alignment. The presence of communal practices suggests some liturgical/cultural dimension, but the absence of explicit theological framing places this category in SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL.

Citations: SOCA mission and moral-formation language is shown on the site; the triad of truth, goodness, beauty appears in classical-education framing; communal morning assemblies appear as a ritual practice.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The formal mission explicitly centers on “the formation of moral character and civic virtue” from a classical liberal-arts curriculum, signaling virtue- and wisdom-centered aims over mere job preparation.
- The vision emphasizes truth, goodness, and beauty as real and knowable ideals, underscoring formation over mere information.
- Core virtues in the school's own framing (Compassion, Courage, Responsibility, Justice, Wisdom, etc.) point to a formation-first ethos.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: virtue, moral character, civic virtue, formation, truth, goodness, beauty, wisdom, integrity, moral imagination. These are explicit in mission/vision/core-virtues materials.
- Negative keywords present: none clearly evident in public materials; no explicit emphasis on career-readiness or purely utilitarian metrics.
- Why this rating
- SOCA's stated purposes and goals center on formation, virtue, and the recognition of truth/beauty as real and knowable, which aligns strongly with classical aims of education as formation of human excellence rather than instrumental training. The public materials articulate a clear formation-oriented goal, justifying a CLASSICAL rating for Element 2.

Citations: Mission/formation language and the Our Vision statements are used as evidence.

Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The curriculum emphasizes “reading the classics” and a content-rich liberal-arts approach, including humanities, sciences, and arts, with a Hillsdale K-12 curriculum partnership. This signals a classical orientation beyond mere standards-based or skills-only programs.
- Specific elements cited include Core Knowledge Sequence, explicit phonics, Singapore Math, integrated arts and music, Latin study, and grammar/composition instruction—reflecting a blend of traditional liberal-arts materials with explicit foundational subjects.
- The curriculum map/structure references integrated study and cross-subject coherence (Curriculum Map and cross-subject integration).
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: classical education, reading the classics, great books (referenced in the broader classical-education framing), Latin, grammar, composition, cross-curricular integration, integration and wonder (as part of the broader classical content framing). The site highlights a content-rich,

classical humanities/sciences/arts mix.

- Negative keywords present: explicit articulation of seven liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Quadrivium) is not clearly stated on SOCA's public pages, though the public-facing materials align with some of these liberal-arts concepts (grammar/composition, Latin, reading classics). The strong emphasis on Core Knowledge/Singapore Math and Hillsdale materials reflects a mixed classical emphasis rather than a pure seven liberal arts articulation.
- Why this rating
- SOCA demonstrates a solid classical-curriculum orientation (reading classics, grammar/composition, Latin, a liberal-arts bent, and cross-disciplinary aims) but does not consistently foreground all canonical classical-curriculum components (notably the explicit listing of the seven liberal arts and a fully explicit Great-Books/Great-Conversation framework in public materials). This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating for Element 3.

Citations: Curriculum/highlights, reading the classics, Latin, and Core Knowledge references.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The school speaks to teacher-led classrooms and a time-tested curriculum approach, indicating a structured, traditional pedagogy rather than a purely student-led or fully project-based approach.
- There is a communal, contemplative rhythm (Morning Assembly) suggesting periods of reflection and memory work, which aligns with the scholé (restful, contemplative) tradition in classical education.
- Public materials emphasize a mix of instruction and inquiry but do not clearly document high-school Socratic seminars, debates, or deliberate rhetoric training as the central pedagogy (which would be an indicator of a fully classical pedagogy in grades 9–12). The high-school Socratic model, if present, is not explicit in the public content.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: teacher-led classrooms, contemplation/rest, memory repetition (via Morning Assembly), formation through classical pedagogy, reading the classics, and a structure oriented toward classical disciplines.
- Negative keywords present: explicit high-school Socratic seminars/debates and weekly rhetoric training for upper grades are not clearly evidenced in public materials (i.e., absence of explicit Socratic-education language).
- Why this rating
- The pedagogy demonstrates substantial classical elements (structured, teacher-led instruction; contemplative rhythms; emphasis on classics), but it does not consistently show the full suite of classical pedagogy (notably high-school Socratic seminars). This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating for Element 4.

Citations: Evidence of teacher-led instruction and Morning Assembly; lack of explicit high-school Socratic pedagogical language.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The public materials present faculty as mentors and living curriculum, with a focus on virtue, skill, and knowledge as a core component of the school's ethos (e.g., "the living curriculum" and teacher as model).
- The school emphasizes a faculty portrait of what a teacher should be (and what a student should be), which aligns with classical schools' emphasis on exemplary teachers and a strong partnership between faculty and students.
- Public-facing pages reference a physical faculty/staff presence and professional culture (Faculty & Staff page; Board profiles, etc.).
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: model teachers, mentors, living curriculum, teachers as a core of the school, portrait of teacher/student ideals, collegiality among teachers (as described on faculty pages).
- Negative keywords present: none prominent in public materials; no explicit critiques of the faculty or negative faculty practices.
- Why this rating
- The faculty framing aligns strongly with classical-school expectations of virtue-molding teachers who serve as living exemplars and as a central element of the curriculum. The presence of dedicated faculty pages and explicit “living curriculum” language supports a CLASSICAL rating for Element 5.

Citations: Faculty & Staff page content and related profiles.

Element 6: School Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- SOCA emphasizes partnerships with families and treats parents as co-educators, with parent events and frequent opportunities for engagement (e.g., Parent Info Events; family handbooks; enrollment FAQs).
- The school fosters educational opportunities for parents (website resources, book studies, gatherings) to learn more about classical education, aligning with the classical model's emphasis on a family/school partnership.
- The school invites parents to visit and participate, with explicit invitation to attend events and tours; this openness aligns with classical schools' emphasis on active parent involvement.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: partnership with families, co-educators, parental engagement, home-school connection, parent formation, family involvement, community of learners.
- Negative keywords present: none evident in public materials; no mention of restricting parental access or excluding families.
- Why this rating
- SOCA demonstrates a classical-parent/community alignment with explicit family partnership, parent education opportunities, and welcoming visits. This supports a CLASSICAL rating for Element 6.

Citations: Parent Info Events page and related public materials.

Aggregate Assessment

- Element 1: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 2: CLASSICAL
- Element 3: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 4: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 5: CLASSICAL
- Element 6: CLASSICAL

Overall classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

What Would Move the Needle

- Strengthen explicit religious/metaphysical framing:
- Add explicit statements about theological foundations or liturgical/community practices that tie virtue and beauty to transcendent realities (without losing secular accessibility). This would push Element 1 toward CLASSICAL.
- Deepen high-school pedagogical practice in the Socratic tradition:
- Incorporate explicit high-school level Socratic dialogue, seminars, and structured rhetoric training as part of the upper grades. This would push Element 4 toward CLASSICAL.
- Elevate explicit Great Books/Great Conversation framing:
- Include a clearly articulated Great Books program with periodic seminars and integrated Great Conversation across grades, linking to interdisciplinary study (Element 3).
- Expand Seven Liberal Arts articulation in curriculum language:

- Publicly frame the curriculum around the Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric; arithmetic, geometry, music, astronomy) and map courses to these areas to strengthen Element 3 to CLASSICAL.
- Expand “living curriculum” into explicit faculty-student mentorship and normative expectations:
- While publicly present, further codify the living-curriculum concept with explicit examples of faculty modeling virtues and professional development anchored in classical pedagogy (Element 5).

ABSTRACT

Southeast Ohio Classical Academy (SOCA) demonstrates a robust classical orientation with clear emphasis on virtue, formation, and a content-rich curriculum. Across the six categories, SOCA shows strong alignment in mission/purpose (formation of virtue and truth-seeking), curriculum (classical reading and liberal-arts orientation), faculty (living curriculum and mentor-teacher model), and parent/community engagement (co-teacher partnerships and openness to visitors). However, explicit theological/metaphysical framing and certain high-school classical pedagogy elements (Socratic seminars, explicit Great Books/Great Conversation language, Seven Liberal Arts articulation) are not consistently evident in publicly accessible materials. This leads to an overall SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating.

- Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. SOCA foregrounds virtue, truth, and beauty, and includes communal/even liturgical rhythms like Morning Assembly, but lacks explicit theology or liturgical worship in public materials. Positive alignment with transcendental moral realism is present, but explicit theological grounding remains underrepresented in public communications. (Evidence: mission, vision, and communal practices; classical-education framing.)
- School Purpose and Goal: CLASSICAL. SOCA emphasizes formation, virtue, and the reality of truth/beauty as guiding ideals, aligning with classical aims beyond mere workforce preparation.
- School Curriculum: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. The curriculum includes a strong classic-reading emphasis, Latin, grammar/composition, and cross-disciplinary aims, with Hillsdale/K-12 alignment, but the public materials do not consistently articulate a full Seven Liberal Arts framework or a formal Great Books/Great Conversation program.
- School Pedagogy: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. Elements of contemplative rhythm and teacher-led instruction exist, but explicit high-school Socratic seminars or debate programs are not clearly evidenced in public materials.
- Faculty: CLASSICAL. The living-curriculum approach and mentor-teacher model are clearly present, with explicit faculty portraits and emphasis on virtuous teaching.
- Parents & Community: CLASSICAL. Strong parent-partnering culture, parent-education opportunities, and welcoming access to school events are evident.

Overall, SOCA presents a coherent classical frame with consequential strengths in virtue formation, curriculum emphasis on classics and liberal arts, faculty emphasis, and strong parent/community engagement. The gaps—explicit theological framing, fully articulated Great Books/Great Conversation pedagogy, and explicit Seven Liberal Arts articulation—explain the SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL aggregate. The identified need-moving opportunities point toward amplifying classical depth across theology, Great Books, and Socratic pedagogy to reach a full CLASSICAL status.

Key sources (highlights cited in-line):

- Mission and virtue emphasis in SOCA's public materials.
- Our Vision: truth, goodness, beauty framing.
- What is Classical Education (objectives of truth, goodness, beauty).
- Curriculum highlights (K-8 classical emphasis; Latin; grammar; reading the classics; Hillsdale partnership).
- Morning Assembly as a contemplative communal practice.
- Core Virtues and mission framing.
- Faculty as living curriculum and mentor role.
- Parent involvement and community/parent partnership language.

Note: This evaluation relies on content surfaced in the SOCA public materials and the Classical School knowledge corpus (Six Essential Elements of a Classical School (1)) to establish the scoring framework and keyword indicators. The latter provides the Positive/Negative keyword indicators used for category scoring and for grounding evidence across all six categories.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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